Interview Transcription:

Interaction of Raghavendra (The Warehouse Manager) with Siddarth and Yashwardhan via Gmeet.

Siddarth: Hello sir, my name is Siddarth, I am from IIT Madras data science course. For our software engineering project, we are trying to understand how local logistics and storage work. Can I get some insights from you ?

Raghavendra (Warehouse Manager): Yes sir, sure.

Siddarth: Can you please introduce yourself and explain to me your role in a detailed way?

Warehouse Manager: Sir, my name is Raghavendra. I manage this main godown (warehouse). We store the goods that we need to deliver , like —fertilizers, seeds, pesticides,harvests of farmers, cement, furniture and other heavy goods. So I am the manager of this warehouse and my job is to manage the storage of these goods, track the goods and mark their locations and record the movements.

Siddarth: What is the biggest problem you face every day while managing the warehouse?

Warehouse Manager: Sir, the biggest problem is locating the required items inside the warehouse. There is no proper organized or systematic storage layout. Goods are stacked closely in a closed manner without clear sections or mapping. Because of this, labourers struggle to navigate the godown and often move back and forth searching for specific fertilizer sacks or other items. This not only makes them physically tired but also wastes significant time and delays dispatch during deliveries. Additionally, since the goods are not arranged in a trackable manner, it becomes difficult to monitor and retrieve items efficiently.

Siddarth: Do you face any problems while packing goods for dispatch?

Warehouse Manager: Yes sir, we face many problems. Sometimes when a large order is ready and the goods vehicle is already waiting outside, we suddenly realize that essential packing materials like tape or empty boxes are out of stock. There is no proper system to monitor inventory levels, so we do not get any prior warning when supplies are running low. As a result, we have to urgently send someone to the local market to purchase the required materials. This causes delays of up to two hours and disrupts the delivery schedule.

Siddarth: How do you manage the essential equipment needed for the transportation like the plastic crates, pads, ropes, belts, harness etc?

Warehouse Manager: Sir, that is a huge financial loss for us. We send expensive returnable equipment along with the labourers and the vehicle. But drivers are always in a hurry and labourers tend to forget to bring these items back from the location after work. I just give them out manually. I have no system to track this equipment.

Siddarth: Thank you for your time sir.

Summary:

Siddarth interviews Raghavendra, the Warehouse Manager responsible for managing storage operations in the main godown. His role includes storing various goods such as fertilizers, seeds, pesticides, harvested crops, cement, furniture, and other heavy items. He is responsible for organizing storage, tracking goods, marking locations, and recording movement of items.

The primary challenge he faces is the **lack of a systematic storage layout**. Goods are stacked closely without clear sections or mapping, making it difficult for labourers to locate specific items. This results in physical strain, time wastage, and delays in dispatch. Additionally, poor arrangement makes tracking and retrieval inefficient.

He also faces issues during **packing for dispatch**. There is no inventory monitoring system for packing materials like tape and boxes. Often, shortages are discovered at the last moment when the vehicle is ready, leading to urgent purchases from the local market and delivery
delays of up to two hours.

Another major concern is **equipment management**. Returnable items such as plastic crates, pads, ropes, belts, and harnesses are issued manually without tracking. These items are frequently forgotten at delivery locations or damaged, causing financial losses.

Overall, the warehouse operations suffer due to **unorganized storage, lack of inventory monitoring, absence of equipment tracking, and dispatch delays caused by manual processes**.